

Payment Card & Cash Handling Policy

Document ID	PCH-01
Title	Payment Card & Cash Handling Policy
Version	1.0
Status	Approved
Effective Date	2024-05-01
Review / Expiry Date	2026-04-30
Owner Department	Finance
Category	Policy
Applies To	Front Office, Food & Beverage, Finance and Duty Managers
Supersedes	None

1. Purpose

1.1 Why this matters

Every day Aurelle properties process thousands of card and cash payments. Mistakes and fraud cost money, but they also damage guest trust. This policy sets out how payments are taken, stored, counted and reconciled.

1.2 Training before handling payments

Employees who process payments must complete Payment Card Handling training before operating a payment terminal or cash drawer.

2. Payment cards

2.1 Card data

Guest payment cards must not be written down; a photocopy of the card may be taken for pre-authorisation only if the guest signs the copy.

2.2 Terminals

Payment terminals are chained to the counter and inspected by the Duty Manager at the start of each night shift for signs of tampering.

2.3 Pre-authorisation

Pre-authorisations must be taken through the terminal at check-in and must not exceed the room rate plus 20% for incidentals.

3. Cash

3.1 Cash floats

Each cashier is issued a personal cash float, which must not exceed USD 800 or local equivalent, and must sign for it at the start of the shift.

3.2 Safe

Floats are stored in individual sealed pouches in the front office safe when not in use.

3.3 Accepted currencies

Each property accepts its local currency and US dollars. Exchange rates are updated daily by Finance.

3.4 Shift close

At the end of every shift, the cash float must be counted by the cashier and a second employee and the result recorded on the Shift Close Form.

3.5 Shift Close Form

The Shift Close Form records the opening float, cash received, cash paid out, the counted total and the names of both employees present at the count.

3.6 Variances

Cash variances greater than USD 10 must be reported to Finance on the same day.

4. Refunds

4.1 Refund method

Refunds must be processed to the original payment method; cash refunds of card payments are prohibited.

4.2 Refund approvals

Refund approval limits follow the Delegation of Authority matrix held by Finance.

5. Finance controls

5.1 Daily reports

The payment terminal produces a settlement report at the end of each business day.

5.2 Reconciliation

Finance must reconcile the daily card settlement reports against the PMS by 12:00 on the following day.

Revision History

Version	Date	Summary of changes
1.0	2024-05-01	Initial payment card and cash handling policy.